

Internal Audit Policy

Relevant Standard(S):

Standards for Registered Training Organisations (RTOs) 2025	• Outcome Standard 4.4 – Systematic monitoring, evaluation and continuous improvement • Outcome Standard 4.1 – Leadership, integrity and accountability • Outcome Standard 4.3 – Risk identification and management • Outcome Standard 2.7 & 2.8 – Feedback, complaints and appeals (system monitoring) • Outcome Standard 1.5 – Validation of assessment (through audit and monitoring processes) • Compliance Requirements – Information, transparency, legislative and regulatory compliance
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Purpose

This policy establishes the framework for SNS College's internal audit system.

It ensures that all RTO operations are systematically monitored, evaluated, and verified for compliance with:

- Standards for Registered Training Organisations (RTOs) 2025, including the Outcome Standards and Compliance Requirements.
- Applicable Commonwealth and Western Australian legislation and regulations; and
- SNS College's internal policies and procedures.

Internal auditing provides assurance to the CEO, management, and regulators that the RTO's governance, training, and compliance systems are effective, legally compliant, and continuously improving.

Internal audits are planned and conducted using a risk-based approach, informed by regulatory change, complaints, validation outcomes, data integrity risks, and previous audit findings.

Internal Audit Principles, Responsibilities and System Controls

Audit Principle	SNS Responsibility	Supporting Policies / Procedures / Records
Audit independence and objectivity are maintained	Ensure internal audits are planned and conducted by personnel independent of the function being audited. Where full independence is not practicable due to organisational size, apply compensating controls including CEO oversight, peer review and evidence-based verification.	• Internal Audit Policy & Procedure • CEO Oversight Records • Audit Reports
Audits are evidence-based and systematic	Conduct audits using documented checklists and objective evidence, including records, data, reports and stakeholder feedback. Ensure findings are supported by verifiable evidence and retained in governance registers.	• Internal Audit Checklist • Audit Register • Evidence Files
Audit planning is risk-based	Determine audit scope, frequency and depth using a risk-based approach informed by regulatory change,	• Compliance Calendar

	complaints, validation outcomes, data risks, previous findings and organisational risk registers.	• Risk Register • Audit Schedule
All regulated operations are subject to audit	Audit training and assessment, student support, data reporting, governance, third-party arrangements and compliance systems across the RTO's scope of registration.	• Internal Audit Schedule • Audit Register • Third-Party Agreements
Findings are documented and acted upon	Record audit findings clearly, including non-compliances, risks and improvement opportunities. Assign corrective and preventive actions with responsible officers and target dates.	• Continuous Improvement (CINC) Register • Audit Reports • Action Tracking Records
Corrective actions are verified and closed	Monitor implementation of corrective actions, verify effectiveness and formally record closure. Escalate overdue or ineffective actions to the CEO for review.	• CINC Register • Compliance & Continuous Improvement Meeting Minutes
Legislative and regulatory compliance is verified	Use internal audits to confirm compliance with Commonwealth and State legislation, regulatory instruments and reporting obligations listed in the Legislative Compliance Register.	• Reporting & Legislative Compliance Register • Audit Register
Audit outcomes inform continuous improvement	Analyse audit outcomes to identify systemic issues and trends. Use findings to inform updates to policies, procedures, TAS documents, staff training and governance controls.	• Continuous Improvement Policy & Register • Management Review Records
Audit results are reported and governed	Report audit outcomes and trends to the CEO and review them through the Quarterly Governance Management Review in accordance with the SNS-PRO-Management Review Procedure to support accountable governance and oversight.	• Audit Reports • CEO Reports • Compliance & CI Meeting Minutes

Scope

This policy applies to all SNS College staff involved in training, assessment, administration, compliance and governance functions.

The internal audit system applies to the monitoring and evaluation of:

- all training and assessment activities delivered under SNS College's scope of registration;
- VET student support, administration and records management systems;
- governance, compliance and risk management functions; and
- third-party delivery arrangements, where applicable.

Internal audits may be conducted across all operational areas of the RTO to provide assurance that services are delivered in accordance with the Standards for Registered Training Organisations (RTOs) 2025, applicable legislation, and SNS College policies and procedures.

Roles And Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Chief Executive Officer (CEO)	Approves the annual internal audit schedule and allocation of resources; reviews internal audit reports and trends; ensures corrective and preventive actions are implemented and effective.
Compliance Manager (Lead Auditor)	Plans, conducts and documents internal audits; maintains the Internal Audit Register; ensures audit findings are recorded in the Continuous Improvement (CINC) Register; monitors, verifies and reports on the closure of audit actions.
Training Manager / Department Heads	Cooperate with internal audits; provide requested evidence and information; implement corrective and preventive actions within agreed timeframes.
All Staff	Participate in internal audits when required and contribute to continuous improvement by providing accurate information, records and feedback.

Principles

SNS College's internal audit program is based on the following principles:

Principle	Description
Independence and objectivity	Internal audits are conducted by personnel independent of the area being audited. Where full independence is not practicable, compensating controls are applied, including CEO oversight, peer review and evidence-based verification.
Evidence-based review	Audit findings are supported by objective evidence, including policies, procedures, records, data and stakeholder feedback.
Risk-based planning	Audit scope, frequency and focus are determined using a risk-based approach informed by regulatory change, complaints, validation outcomes, data integrity risks and previous audit findings.
Transparency and accountability	Audit results, findings and actions are documented, reported to the CEO and monitored to closure.
Integration and improvement	Audit outcomes are integrated with the Continuous Improvement framework and used to inform updates to policies, procedures, TAS documents and staff development.
Legislative vigilance	Internal audits verify compliance with all applicable legislative and regulatory obligations recorded in the Legislative Compliance Register.

Governance and Integration

Internal audit outcomes are reviewed through established governance mechanisms and are integrated with:

- the **Continuous Improvement (CINC) Register** for corrective and preventive action tracking;
- the **Reporting & Legislative Compliance Register** for verification of legislative and regulatory compliance; and
- Monthly RTO Operational Meeting records (for operational follow-up); and
- Quarterly Governance Management Review records (for formal governance oversight).

This integrated approach ensures internal audits contribute to whole-of-organisation governance and continuous improvement.

Monitoring, Evaluation and Continuous Improvement

- A full-scope internal audit is conducted at least annually.
- Additional targeted audits are conducted where required, including in response to identified risks, complaints, validation outcomes, regulatory change or adverse performance indicators.
- Internal audit results are summarised in the Internal Audit Register and reported to the CEO.
- The Compliance Manager ensures all corrective and preventive actions are implemented, verified for effectiveness and formally closed.

- Lessons learned from internal audits are used to improve policies, procedures, training and assessment systems, and staff capability.
- Internal audit findings and risk impacts are formally reviewed at the Quarterly Governance Management Review to determine systemic implications and required strategic actions.

Tools and References

The internal audit system is supported by the following tools and records:

- TEM-SNS-Pre Internal Audit Checklist.xlsx
- Internal Audit Register
- Continuous Improvement (CINC) Register
- Reporting & Legislative Compliance Register
- Compliance Calendar
- Compliance & Continuous Improvement Meeting Minutes

Related Documents

- SNS Continuous Improvement Policy & Procedure
- SNS Reporting & Records Management Policy & Procedure
- SNS Transition Policy & Procedure
- SNS Validation Policy & Procedure

Note:

The Internal Audit Register is maintained within the Reporting & Legislative Compliance Register. Each audit record includes the audit ID, scope, findings, corrective actions, responsible officer, target dates and verification outcomes. This approach provides a consolidated and auditable record of systematic monitoring, risk management and continuous improvement in accordance with the Standards for Registered Training Organisations (RTOs) 2025.

Version Control

Version Control Table					
Date	Summary of Modifications	Modified by	Version	Date of Implementation	Next Review Date
15/11/2025	New document – establishes Internal Audit framework and integrates with CINC & Legislative Compliance systems.	SNS College	1.0	15/11/2025	15/11/2026
25/01/2026	Alignment to 2025 Standards	SNS College	2.0	25/01/2026	25/01/2027

RTO INFORMATION

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